

Employee Handbook

Policy owner	People & Administration
Effective date	September 2026
Applies to	Northstar IT employees

Welcome

Northstar expects employees to understand the basic rules that apply to their work, know where to ask questions, and raise concerns when something is not working. This handbook summarizes the employment practices and workplace expectations that apply across the company. More detailed policies, procedures, benefit plans, and written agreements apply where relevant and control when they provide more specific requirements.

1. Employment Principles

Northstar provides equal employment opportunity and makes employment decisions based on legitimate business needs, qualifications, performance, conduct, and other lawful factors. Discrimination, harassment, and retaliation based on a characteristic protected by law are prohibited. Employees who need a workplace accommodation should contact People & Administration so the company can engage in the appropriate interactive process.

Nothing in this handbook creates a contract of employment or changes rights provided by applicable law or a written agreement. Northstar may revise policies, practices, and benefits as business needs or legal requirements change.

2. Respectful and Fair Workplace

Employees are expected to communicate professionally and avoid conduct that interferes with another employee’s ability to work safely and effectively. Harassment, discrimination, sexual assault, retaliation, threats, and intimidation are prohibited. Employees may report a concern to their manager, People & Administration, the Chief Operating Officer, or another executive when an alternate reporting path is needed. Employees are not required to confront the person involved before making a report.

Managers who receive a complaint must notify People & Administration and should not conduct informal side investigations or promise secrecy. The Workplace Fairness, Anti-Harassment & Complaint Reporting Policy provides the full reporting and review process.

3. Work Time, Pay, and Timekeeping

Nonexempt employees must accurately record all time worked. Working off the clock, failing to record work time, or asking another employee to work without recording time is prohibited. Overtime should be approved in advance when practicable, but all hours actually worked must still be reported and will be paid in accordance with applicable law.

Employees should review time and pay records and report suspected errors promptly. Managers may not direct an employee to underreport hours, change time records to avoid overtime, or delay reporting a payroll issue.

4. Meals and Rest Periods

Northstar provides meal and rest periods to nonexempt employees in accordance with Oregon requirements. Employees are expected to take required breaks and may not routinely skip them to complete more work. If workload, staffing, scheduling, or a manager’s direction prevents an employee from taking a required break, the employee should notify the manager or People & Administration so the issue can be addressed.

5. Attendance, Scheduling, PTO, and Sick Time

Employees are expected to report for scheduled work, be ready to begin work at the scheduled time, and follow the call-out process established for their team. Absences and schedule changes should be communicated as early as reasonably possible. Protected leave or sick time will not be treated as an attendance violation when used in accordance with applicable law and company policy.

Oregon sick time is administered separately from other PTO programs. Employees should contact People & Administration with questions about protected sick time, eligibility, or how different leave programs interact.

6. Protected Leave and Accommodations

Northstar administers qualifying leave under Paid Leave Oregon and other applicable leave laws, including OFLA and FMLA where eligibility and coverage requirements are met. Employees do not need to determine which law applies before asking for help. An employee who expects to miss work for an extended period, needs recurring time away for a qualifying reason, or needs an accommodation should contact People & Administration as soon as practical.

7. Safety, Security, and Incident Reporting

Employees are responsible for following site, equipment, access-control, emergency, and incident-response procedures. Hazards, injuries, threats, workplace violence, suspicious security activity, lost devices, and possible data exposures must be reported promptly. Employees may not share passwords, disable security tools, or bypass access controls for convenience.

8. Technology, Confidentiality, and Company Information

Company systems, devices, records, and information are provided for authorized business use. Employees must protect customer, employee, financial, security, and proprietary information from unauthorized access, use, or disclosure. Access to information is based on business need and does not give an employee permission to share or use the information for another purpose.

AI tools may be used only in accordance with the Acceptable Use of Artificial Intelligence & Data Protection Policy. Confidential or restricted information may not be entered into an unapproved AI service. Employees are responsible for reviewing AI-assisted work before it is relied on or shared.

9. Performance and Conduct

Employees are expected to perform assigned work, follow reasonable instructions, communicate professionally, protect company and customer resources, meet role requirements, and comply with applicable policies. When performance or conduct issues arise, Northstar may use coaching, training, process changes, performance management, corrective action, or other measures appropriate to the circumstances.

Employees are encouraged to raise workload concerns, process failures, control gaps, safety issues, or ethical concerns rather than work around them silently. Raising a good-faith concern is not itself a performance problem.

10. Remote and Hybrid Work

Remote and hybrid employees are held to the same confidentiality, timekeeping, performance, availability, safety, and security expectations as employees working onsite. Employees must use approved devices, systems, networks, and collaboration tools and follow any role-specific remote-work agreement. Remote work does not authorize an employee to relocate, change scheduled hours, or perform work from another jurisdiction without approval when company rules require it.

11. Company Property and Records

Employees are expected to safeguard company property and return it when requested or when employment ends. Business records created or maintained as part of an employee's work must be stored in approved systems and retained or disposed of according to company requirements. Employees may not intentionally destroy, conceal, or alter records that are subject to a legal hold, investigation, audit, or other retention requirement.

12. Separation From Employment

Employees leaving Northstar must return company property, protect confidential information after separation, and complete required transition steps. System access may be limited or removed as part of the separation process. Final pay, benefit notices, records, and other separation requirements will be handled under applicable law and company procedure.

13. Where to Get Help

Topic	Primary Contact
Pay, leave, accommodation, policy interpretation	People & Administration
Work priorities, scheduling, performance	Manager
Safety hazard or injury	Manager and designated safety channel
Harassment, discrimination, retaliation	Manager, People & Administration, COO, or alternate executive
Security, device, access, or data incident	IT / Security
Ethics or conflict requiring an alternate reporting path	COO or executive leadership

Employee Acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I received the Northstar IT Employee Handbook. I understand that I am responsible for reading the handbook, asking questions when I need clarification, and following applicable company policies and procedures. I understand that this handbook is a summary of company practices and may be updated as laws, benefits, systems, or business needs change.

Employee name: _____ Date: _____

Signature: _____